

Lesson 3 - Gradients

⇒ In simple 2-d dy/dx was a line which will become a plane in 3-d and so on.

Tangent plane

⇒ We find tangent plane in 3-d by fixing one var at a time & finding 2 tangent lines.

⇒ With 2 tangent lines, we find the tangent plane.

eg $f(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$

$$\frac{d}{dx}(f(x, y)) = 2x$$

$$\frac{d}{dy}(f(x, y)) = 2y$$

Partial Derivatives

⇒ Partial derivative is a derivative with respect to 1 variable while keeping all other vars constant.

eg $f(x, y, z) = \dots$

$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} f(x, y, z)$
partial derivative wrt x
considered as constants

$$f(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} = 2x$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} = 2y$$

eg $f(x, y) = 3x^2y^3$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} = 6xy^3$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} = 9x^2y^2$$

Gradients

⇒ Gradient is the vector of all partial derivatives.

Gradient of $f(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$

$$= \begin{bmatrix} \partial f / \partial x_1 \\ \partial f / \partial x_2 \\ \vdots \\ \partial f / \partial x_n \end{bmatrix} = \underline{\underline{\nabla f}}$$

eg find gradient of $f(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$
at $(2, 3)$

$$\nabla f = \begin{bmatrix} \partial f / \partial x \\ \partial f / \partial y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 2x \\ 2y \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\nabla f_{(2,3)} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \cdot 2 \\ 2 \cdot 3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix}$$

Similar to how solving the derivative for single variable function gives us the minima / maxima information.



Solving for $\nabla f = 0$ i.e. solving for gradient to be equal to zero vector gives us the minima / maxima in higher dimensions

⇒ eg Sauna problem [5x5 case]

$$T(x,y) = 85 - \frac{1}{90} x^2 (x-6) y^2 (y-6)$$

⇒ Now to find the coldest place
in sauna →

$$\nabla f = \begin{bmatrix} \partial f / \partial x \\ \partial f / \partial y \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} = -\frac{1}{90} y^2 (y-6) (3x^2 - 12x) = 0$$

$$\boxed{x = 0, 4}$$

$$\boxed{y = 0, 6}$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} = -\frac{1}{90} x^2 (x-6) (3y^2 - 12y) = 0$$

$$\boxed{y = 0, 4}$$

$$\boxed{x = 0, 6}$$

Now to find whether they are minimus or maxinus, lets check their second derivatives.

$$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2} = \frac{-1}{90} y^2 (y-6) (6x-12) - \frac{1}{90} \cdot x \cdot (-3) \cdot 6$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y^2} = -\frac{1}{90} x^2 (x-6) (6y-12)$$

$$@ (0,0) \rightarrow \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2}, \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y^2} \quad [maxima]$$

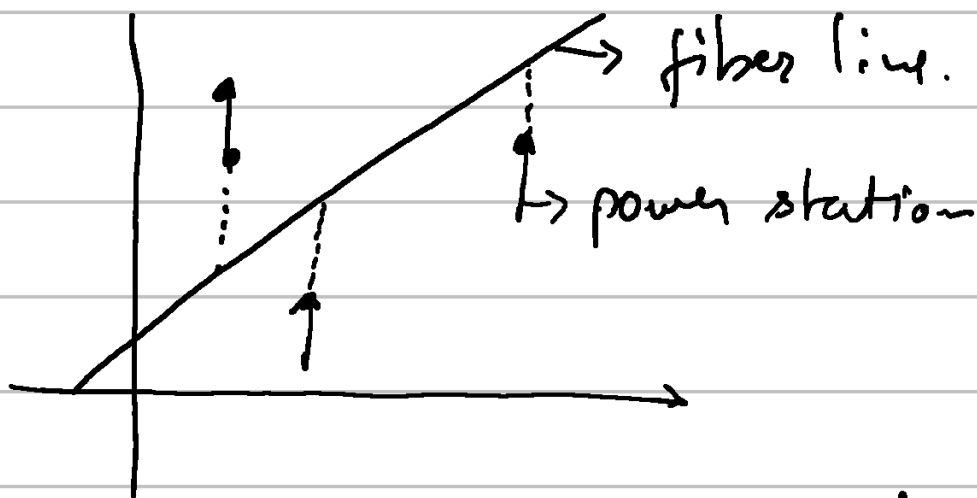
$$@ (0,4) \rightarrow -ve, 0 \quad [maxima]$$

$$@ (4,0) \rightarrow 0, -ve \quad [maxima]$$

$$@ \boxed{(4,4)} \rightarrow \frac{18}{10}, \frac{18}{10} \quad [minima]$$

$x=6, y=6$ discarded as out of bounds for the given problem.

⇒ Powerline example



Reduce the cost of putting down the fiber for power stations.

Wires can only be laid parallel to y-axis to connect fiber line & power station.

cost = square of wire length.

$$\Rightarrow y = mx + b$$

$$P = (x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2) \dots (x_n, y_n)$$

$$C_1 = (y_1 - mx_1 - b)^2$$

$$\vdots$$

$$C_n = (y_n - mx_n - b)^2$$

$$\Sigma \text{Cost} = \sum_{i=1}^n C_i = (y_1 - mx_1 - b)^2 + \dots$$

This cost function becomes our function to minimize.

Lets find its gradient $\rightarrow$

$$\nabla C = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial C}{\partial m} \\ \frac{\partial C}{\partial b} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\frac{\partial C}{\partial m} = -2x_1(y_1 - mx_1 - b) - 2x_2(y_2 - mx_2 - b) \dots$$

$$\frac{\partial C}{\partial b} = -2(y_1 - mx_1 - b) - 2(y_2 - mx_2 - b) \dots$$

Now, solving these for particular (x, y) -- would yield us our answer. Let's see if a general form exists.

$$\frac{\partial C}{\partial m} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x_1 y_1 - m x_1^2 - b x_1 + x_2 y_2 - m x_2^2 - b x_2 \dots$$

$$x_1^2 m + x_1 b + x_2^2 m + x_2 b \dots = x_1 y_1 + x_2 y_2 \dots$$

$$m(x_1^2 + x_2^2 \dots) + b(x_1 + x_2) = x_1 y_1 + x_2 y_2 \dots$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{\partial C}{\partial b} = 0$$

$$m(x_1 + x_2 \dots) + n b = y_1 + y_2 \dots$$

Yeah, the general form does not seem to be pretty.

eg $(1, 2)$ $(2, 5)$ $(3, 3)$

lets use the general form.

$$m(1+4+9) + b(1+2+3) = 2+10+8$$

$$14m + 6b = 21 \quad \text{①}$$

$$6m + 3b = 10 \quad \text{②}$$

$$14m - 12m = 1$$

$$m = 0.5$$

$$6b = 21 - 7$$

$$b = \frac{14}{6} = \frac{7}{3}$$